

Chapter 121-3

//

When Liang Shi returned to the crew again, Yan Xi was the first to see her and asked who she had gone to fight with.

"I was joking. Did you actually believe it?" Liang Shi said casually.

Yan Xi: "...How boring."

Liang Shi sat on a bench. The crew had already resumed normal operations.

It happened to be lunch break, and when Yan Xi went to get boxed meals, she brought one back for her as well. Today's boxed meal was decent—one meat dish, two vegetable dishes, and a soup—just that the rice portion was small.

Liang Shi asked about it, and Yan Xi said, "The director thinks we've been eating too many boxed meals and getting fat, which doesn't look good on camera, so he's having us eat less carbs."

Liang Shi: "....."

The mysterious incidents on set ultimately concluded with a supernatural explanation.

Yan Xi was dismissive of this, "We're people of the new era now. Why would anyone still believe in this kind of stuff? That Daoist priest is obviously just scamming money."

Liang Shi nodded silently beside her.

But whether or not the Daoist priest was scamming money wasn't important. What mattered was that it had calmed everyone's anxious hearts.

Finally, it was no longer like the past few days, where if you stayed in the bathroom a bit too long, you could hear two or three groups of people telling these supernatural stories.

They told them so convincingly that it left everyone feeling listless and dispirited.

Once people were no longer anxious, work efficiency improved.

No matter how you looked at it, the director's thirty thousand yuan was money well spent.

Whether it was psychological or whether this stuff was really somewhat mysterious like the Daoist priest said, who knew.

In any case, the filming afterward went fairly smoothly.

Even if someone in the crew got sick, it was just one person at a time, either from staying up too late or from an old illness relapsing. But there were no more situations like before—getting sick without any warning and being unable to find the cause, ultimately having to blame it all on metaphysics.

From then on, they no longer heard crew members talking about supernatural incidents they or their friends had encountered. But what followed was everyone making plans to visit Yunfeng Mountain together.

Liang Shi heard about it a few times but had no particular thoughts.

However, two days later, Zhao Ying knocked on Liang Shi's door during break time.

That day happened to have no scenes for Zhao Ying. It should have been a pleasant rest day, but there were heavy dark circles under her eyes. After entering Liang Shi's room, she first gulped down several mouthfuls of water, then sat on that cheap wooden chair and said, "I can't take it anymore."

Liang Shi was surprised, "What's wrong?"

Zhao Ying closed her eyes briefly and let out a light breath, "Shu Yi definitely has a mental illness."

Liang Shi: "?"

"She knocked on my door last night and pinned me down and beat me." As Zhao Ying spoke, she lifted her bangs to reveal a three-centimeter wound on her forehead.

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi immediately went to rummage through her suitcase. Before she could ask what exactly was going on with Shu Yi, she was already looking for her portable first-aid kit while saying, "Why didn't you treat the wound?"

Zhao Ying sighed, "My whole body has gone numb."

Liang Shi: "....."

She first helped Zhao Ying treat the wound on her forehead. It looked like it had been scratched by something sharp, but it wasn't serious—it had already scabbed over by now.

While Liang Shi was disinfecting it, Zhao Ying sucked in several sharp breaths of cold air, speaking weakly, "This has nothing to do with ghosts or monsters. It's purely that Shu Yi has a mental illness."

"I filmed with her this morning and didn't notice any problems," Liang Shi said.

Zhao Ying was in so much pain that the hand pressing down on her hair was clenching hard, "That's the most outrageous part."

"She knocked on my door at two in the morning last night. She scared me so much I'm about to have a nervous breakdown." Zhao Ying said, "Two in the morning! I was in the middle of a dream... Can you even imagine?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Just hearing about it felt suffocating.

"I can't continue filming this drama." After Liang Shi applied a bandage, Zhao Ying let her bangs down, "Either she goes or I go."

Zhao Ying pressed on her temples, "I've been playing the Great Compassion Mantra¹ before bed now, but I never expected that the real disaster would be man-made!"²

Liang Shi didn't know how to comfort her. Seeing that Zhao Ying was completely out of sorts, she must have been tormented quite badly.

"Before I worked with Shu Yi, I heard this person was pretty decent." Zhao Ying complained in a rambling manner, "Why didn't anyone tell me she sleepwalks and has a mental illness?"

"If she doesn't get treatment soon, I'm going to become mentally ill!" Zhao Ying said.

If this had happened before the drama started filming, everything could have been negotiated.

Given Zhao Ying's current status in the industry, she could just say she didn't have time in her schedule and make arrangements with the director for the next project. Although the director would be unhappy about it, he would give her that courtesy.

But now Zhao Ying had already filmed nearly half of her scenes, and the same was true for Shu Yi.

Replacing an actor at this point—unless the actor had caused a huge scandal that would affect the drama's broadcast, or had been directly blacklisted by the media—was not something anyone would choose to do.

Even if they wanted to replace an actor, they would have to recheck actor schedules, which was very troublesome.

So once many dramas were put on hold, who knew when they would resume filming—it could be ages.³

Most just naturally waited for the project to fall through.

But "Mo Guang"⁴ was a big production. The director was aiming for major awards next year.

Two Best Actress winners, a director who had made multiple bids for international awards—even during the preparation stage, who knew how many celebrities had been brought in. It was practically a dream role that everyone in the industry wanted.

If something went wrong midway, it would definitely cause a stir in the industry.

Footnotes:

¹ **Great Compassion Mantra (大悲咒):** A Buddhist dharani (chant) associated with the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara. In Chinese folk belief, playing or reciting this mantra is thought to ward off evil spirits and provide protection, which is why Zhao Ying plays it before bed to calm her nerves.

² The original text has a censored portion (□□) which likely contained words that were filtered by the publishing platform. Based on context, the sentence means she didn't expect the disaster to be caused by a person rather than supernatural forces.

³ **Who knew when—it could be ages (不知猴年馬月):** A Chinese expression literally meaning "who knows which year of the monkey or month of the horse," referring to an indefinitely long time in the future. It's used when something is delayed with no clear end date in sight.

⁴ **"Mo Guang" (餘光):** The title of the drama being filmed. It translates to "Afterglow" or "Lingering Light."